Day 64 - Skinner's Woods, Len Holley, Chris Walker

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 83 · Skinner's Bluff & Colpoy's Bay

12.4 km / 7.7 mi	~3.9 h	5.2 km new	183 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

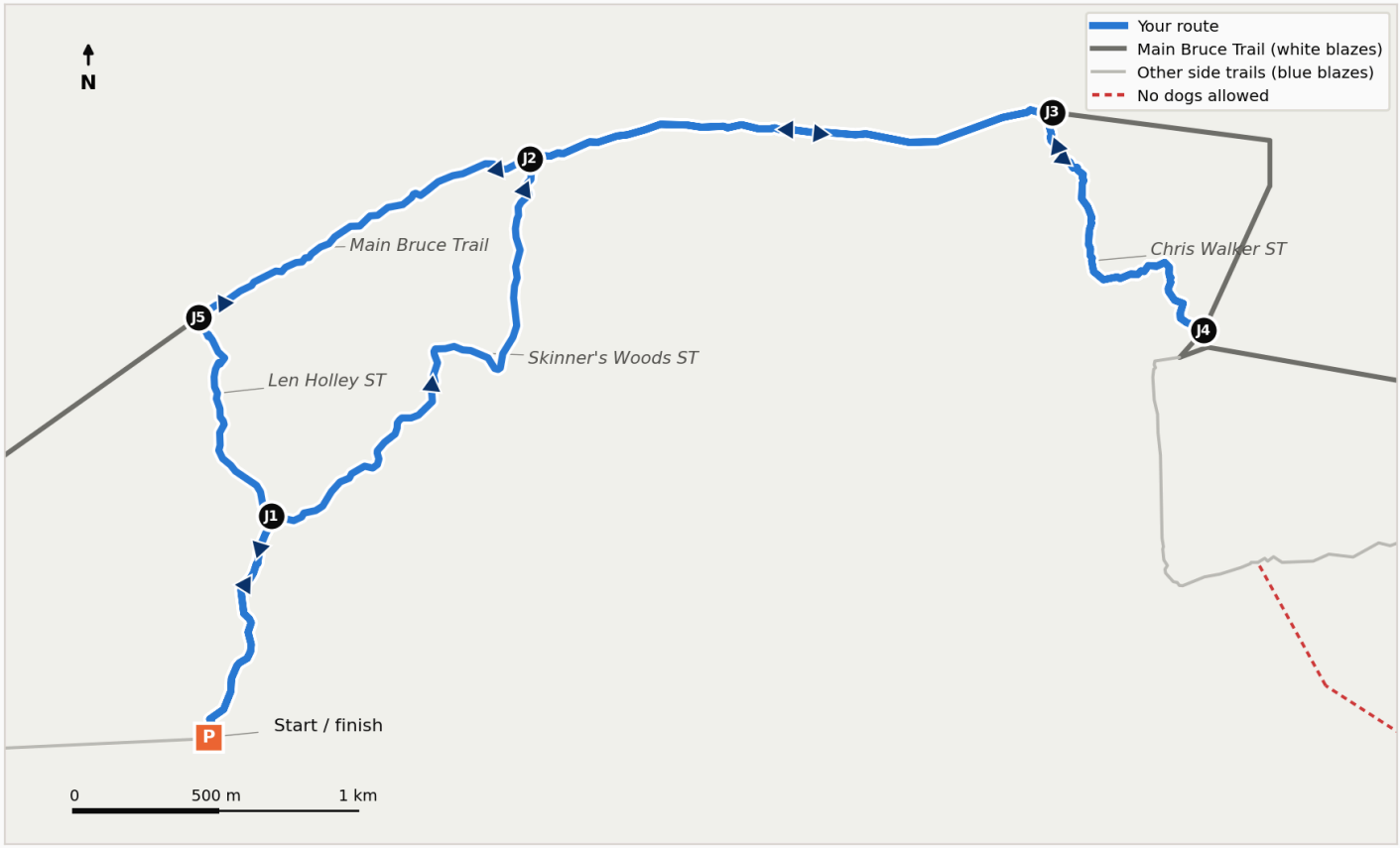
Park: Roadside parking on Gleason Lake Rd where the Curly Harnden Side Trail meets the Len Holley Side Trail. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day64_hike083.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Skinner's Woods Side Trail (2.1 km); Len Holley Side Trail (1.8 km); Chris Walker Side Trail (1.3 km)

Route map

Day 64 | 12.4 km (7.7 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside parking on Gleason Lake Rd, where the Curly Harnden and Len Holley side trails meet (near the Colpoy's Range Rd corner).
- **Len Holley Side Trail:** A blue-blazed trail heading north about 1.8 km from Gleason Lake Rd to the main Bruce Trail. You walk it both ways.
- **Skinner's Bluff on the main trail:** The main trail follows the top of the Escarpment, with views across Colpoy's Bay. blogTO calls it a fairly difficult hike along the cliff's edge, climbing steadily to several lookouts. From the top you can see White Cloud, Griffith and Hay islands. Keep Zappy on a short leash at the lookouts.
- **Skinner's Woods and Chris Walker side trails:** The Chris Walker Side Trail is a 1.3 km blue-blazed loop off the main trail. We didn't find a description of the Skinner's Woods Side Trail.
- **Length:** At 12.6 km this is a long day. The Sydenham club notes many good picnic spots along the Skinner's Bluff stretch.
- **Dogs:** Zappy stays on leash. The Sydenham club asks that dogs be leashed and kept under control, especially near farmland, and suggests an orange or fluorescent harness or bandana in hunting season so a dog isn't mistaken for wildlife.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on Gleason Lake Rd where the Curly Harnden Side Trail meets the Len…. Head north-east on the blue-blazed Len Holley Side Trail.

0.9	0.6	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Skinner's Woods Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Len Holley Side Trail goes off on your left.)
2.9	1.8	J2: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
4.8	3.0	J3: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Chris Walker Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
6.1	3.8	J4: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
7.4	4.6	J3: Turn sharp left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
9.3	5.8	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the Skinner's Woods Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
10.6	6.6	J5: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Len Holley Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
11.5	7.1	J1: Junction. Turn right to stay on the Len Holley Side Trail, heading south. (the Skinner's Woods Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
12.4	7.7	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails, blogTO and the Sydenham Bruce Trail Club.